

Operations Department
Shatava/Donahue
March 2026

Baseball Cage Project-

With the change in weather, we were able to continue our baseball batting cage project. We now have three batting cages up at our baseball facility. We are currently working with a fencing contractor to get a new fence installed around the cages and a temporary fence in the outfield to get us through this season. Phase two of this project will be to install new fencing around the entire field, move the bull pens into a fenced area within the field, and install a new backstop. These improvements will help to bring our baseball facility up to the same standard as our softball facility and improve the overall experience for athletes, spectators, and the community.

Summer Planning-

With construction projects happening across the district this summer, we have started the planning phases for how we will handle all the work that needs to be done in our buildings, along with the construction projects. As a reminder, North Ridge and Dallas Center Elementary will be closed for most of the summer while we perform construction projects at these sites. All Elementaries will have playground work done on site this summer. This will create challenges for custodial staffing, daycares, and building operations. We have been in contact with our daycares to work through options for them that work for both parties. This is still in progress, but the conversations have started. Our custodial crews this summer will be moving around and will be supporting all buildings. A rough draft of this plan breaks the summer into 3 phases: putting multiple resources into one building to complete that building, then working our way across the district, with the ability to have all resources ready for North Ridge and DCE when they are ready. This will be an exciting and challenging time for our operations department, but we will ensure each building is ready to go for the start of the 26-27 school year. It will look different, but we will continue to have high standards for cleaning and maintenance of our facilities.

Building Walkthroughs-

Before Spring break and right after the operations directors meet with building leaders and their teams to walk the buildings, get an administrative and building perspective on which projects need to be taken care of this summer. These walkthroughs have been very helpful for gaining perspective on what is needed in building. We have found some flooring issues in the building that we will be addressing, and looking at a new product for the walk-off material in our buildings. We have also looked at paint and other cosmetic needs in our buildings. As we collect this data, we will begin meeting with vendors and develop an action plan for this summer. All this data, along with our budgeting, will inform what we can get done this summer and the summer project list.

One area I want to highlight is the cleanliness of all of our buildings. Our current custodial staff has done a fantastic job this school year. Buildings look good and are well-maintained. I want to highlight our custodial staff and the partnership with Baker Group through REMI (Insurance provider). These two groups have done a great job of improving the overall look, feel, and safety of our buildings.

Bond Update-

On the first three projects, we had our first bid day on March 24th. This was for the Fire Alarm system for North Ridge and DCE, the HVAC controls for North Ridge and DCE, and finally, the playground projects across the district. These are exciting projects for us to get started.

The next projects going out to bid will be the Construction at North Ridge and DCE. The North Ridge project includes New heat pumps in the building, a new secure entry, a remodel of the existing office area, new windows in the classroom areas, tuckpointing around the building exterior, and a new communication system throughout the building. At DCE, we will be implementing a new communication system throughout the building, a new secure entry into the main office, tuckpointing around the outside of the building, and reconfiguring the main office, principal office, guidance office, instructional coach office, and storage. These two projects will be the larger construction projects that are being done this summer in the district. They are scheduled to go out to bid on March 27.

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